



Examination Report

Religious Education

6893

EGCSE

2025

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General comments

There has been an increase in the number of candidates who sat for the 2025 examination from 17,832 to 20,464. This increase was largely due to the participation of thirty-two (32) pilot schools implementing the EGCSE four-year programme, each of which presented two (2) cohorts of candidates. Overall, the performance of the 2025 cohort was broadly comparable to that of the 2024. However, there was a wide variation in marks, ranging from a high of 80 out of 80 to a low of 2 out of 80. This indicates inconsistent performance across the cohort, with a significant proportion of candidates scoring between 30 and 40 marks.

Although the use of bullet points was not widespread, it remained an issue for some candidates. Candidates are expected to present their responses in continuous prose in order to demonstrate a coherent line of reasoning. Additionally, some candidates drew extra lines for their responses, suggesting a misunderstanding of the allocated answer space. Candidates should be guided to write their responses clearly within the spaces provided

Assessment Objectives:

Assessment Objective A01: Knowledge and Understanding

Generally, most candidates performed fairly well, demonstrating adequate knowledge and providing thorough, well-developed, and substantial responses. Compared to 2024, most candidates demonstrated a good knowledge of the biblical accounts as recorded by St Luke. Many accounts were comprehensive and reflected a high level of accuracy of the subject matter. However, some candidates demonstrated very limited knowledge of Biblical accounts which includes small relevant material. In a few cases, responses were irrelevant or inaccurate, which resulted in very low marks. To achieve higher marks, it is essential for candidates to focus on the accuracy and depth of their knowledge and to structure their answers in a clear and logical manner.

Understanding, Analysis, and Interpretation:

In terms of understanding, analysis, and interpretation, some candidates demonstrated a solid grasp of the subject matter and provided well-developed responses. While the majority showed a good understanding of the content, there remains a need for improved answer structure and more comprehensive interpretation of the questions in order to secure upper-level marks. Learners must be taught to differentiate between the main point and substantiation. Common mistakes that were noted, candidates confused questions that required an analysis of lessons learnt and character traits.

Assessment Objective AO2: Evaluation

Candidates demonstrated an ability to present a range of viewpoints supported by some justified arguments and discussion. However, a number of responses relied on social or general arguments rather than religious arguments when explaining the significance of the issues raised. As a result, such responses could not be credited beyond Level 3.

There was also a recurring issue in which some candidates failed to support their evaluations with appropriate Biblical evidence. In particular, several candidates did not refer to the given source in Question 1, despite this being essential for access to the higher levels of the mark scheme. Candidates should be encouraged to refer back explicitly to the Biblical passages provided in part (a)(i) When responding to evaluation questions and to make clear reference to the source where required.

In addition, a small number of candidates did not clearly articulate a personal viewpoint or effectively acknowledge alternative perspectives. When presenting an opposing point of view, candidates are encouraged to clearly show that they are referring to another perspective by using expressions such as *“others may say,” “some may argue,”* or *“On the other hand, some argue that...,”* rather than phrases like *“I also think.”*

Comments on specific questions

Question 1

Few candidates made effective use of the picture source in their answers to Question 1 and were therefore able to achieve Level 4. Although candidates were required to use the source in all three parts of the question, some failed to incorporate it meaningfully into their responses. As a result, their answers were restricted to a maximum of Level 3.

(a)(i) Give an account of the miracle shown in the source.

[6]

This question was generally well answered by many candidates. High-level responses provided a clear, orderly account of the Parable of the Great Banquet, making appropriate and relevant use of the source to support their accounts. These candidates demonstrated an understanding of the narrative, effectively integrating details from the picture source into their accounts.

However, some candidates referred to the source in a superficial or poorly qualified manner, for example by making vague statements such as *“as seen in the source,”* without stating what is seen in the source. Such

responses could not be awarded marks beyond Level 3. Other candidates merely described what was visible in the source without developing their ideas or adding meaningful narration, which limited their responses to Level 1.

A small number of candidates failed to engage with the source material altogether and wrote about unrelated events, such as the Feeding of the Five Thousand, Last Supper and Wedding at Cana. These off-topic responses demonstrated a lack of understanding of the question and scored level 0.

Expected response:

A man once gave a great banquet, and invited many; And at the time for the banquet he sent his servant to say to those who had been invited, 'Come, for all is now ready'; But they all alike began to make excuses, the first said to him, 'I have bought a field, and I must go out and see it, I pray you have me excused'; And another said, 'I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I go to examine them, I pray you have me excused'; And another said, 'I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come'; So the servant came and reported this to his master; Then the householder in anger said to his servant, 'Go out quickly to the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in the poor, maimed, blind and lame'; And the servant said, 'Sir, what you commanded has been done, and still there is room'; The master said to the servant, 'Go out to the highways and hedges, and compel people to come in, that my house may be filled; For I tell you, none of those men who were invited shall taste my banquet. (Luke 14:15-24)

(ii) Explain two characteristics of Luke's gospel revealed in this parable.

[6]

This part of the question was answered well by the majority of candidates. However, some struggled to manipulate the source effectively and therefore achieved a Level 3 response. Some candidates did not fully address the question, as they focused on broader themes of Luke's Gospel rather than explicitly linking its distinctive characteristics to the parable of the Great Banquet. For example, some responses discussed themes such as gospel of prayer and worship, gospel of women and gospel of the Holy Spirit, which were not directly evidenced within the parable.

Expected responses:

Gospel of food - the parable is about the master who invited people to a banquet; **Universalism of the gospel** - the kingdom of God is for Jews and Gentiles; **Gospel of the poor** - the master said the servants should go and invite the poor along the streets; **Gospel of the sick**- the master said the servants should go and invite the maimed, the blind and the lame.

(b) Do you think the parable of the great banquet is relevant to Christians today? Give reasons for your answer and show you have thought about different points of view.

[8]

A few candidates were able to present a range of religious viewpoints on the relevance of the Parable of the Great Banquet. However, even those who offered religious arguments some failed to make reference to the source, which meant they could not progress to Level 4. The majority were unable to clearly explain the significance of the parable for Christians today. Many focused primarily on practical examples, such as Christians inviting the poor for meals at home or in church settings and some argued about the charitable deeds done by Christians. As a result, these responses lacked deeper religious reflections and could not be awarded higher level marks.

Expected Responses:

YES

It assures that all are still welcome in the kingdom of God - the householder told the servant to go to the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in the poor, maimed, blind and lame so Christians are also welcome in the Kingdom of God; **It encourages Christians to be receptive to the word of God** - if Christians reject the invitation from God, it will always be extended to others; **God is still patiently waiting for his people to repent** - in the parable the master was patient with the guests.

NO

Entry into the kingdom of God is for everyone - yet in the parable the invitation was initially for a selected few; **Entry into the kingdom of God is by grace** - in the parable God invited the people, but Christians today are saved by grace.

Question 2

This question was well done by a majority of candidates.

(i) Give an account of the temptations of Jesus.

[6]

This part of the question was answered well by the majority of candidates. Many were able to present a thorough and well-developed account of the conversation between Jesus and the devil in chronological order. However, some candidates confused the sequence of the temptations, which limited their responses and prevented them from progressing beyond Level 3. Additionally, some candidates summarized the account and, in doing so, missed critical information, resulting in lower scores.

Expected response:

The devil said to Jesus, "If you are the Son of God, command this stone to become bread". Jesus answered him, "It is written, 'Man shall not live by bread alone'"; The devil took him up, and showed him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time; He said to him, "To you I will give all this authority and their glory; for it has been delivered to me, and I give it to whom I will; If you, then, will worship me, it shall all be yours."; Jesus answered him, "It is written, 'You shall worship the Lord your God, and him only shall you serve.' And he took him to Jerusalem, and set him on the pinnacle of the temple, and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down from here; for it is written, 'He will give his angels charge of you, to guard you,' and 'On their hands they will bear you up, lest you strike your foot against a stone.' And Jesus answered him, "It is said, 'You shall not tempt the Lord your God.'" (Luke 4: 3-12)

(ii) Explain two lessons learnt from the temptations of Jesus. [6]

Most candidates answered this question well, typically providing an analysis of the lessons learned from the temptations of Jesus, such as reliance on Scripture, the devil's opportunistic nature, God as the only one worthy of worship, and the cunning nature of the devil. However, some candidates focused on analysing the character traits of Jesus rather than addressing the specific demands of the question.

Expected response:

Rely on scripture to conquer the devil - in all three temptations Jesus turned down the devil using scripture;
The devil awaits for opportune time - The devil waited for Jesus to be vulnerable- to be hungry; **Human nature/ Part of everyday life** - Jesus was tempted so we are bound to fall into temptation **There is only God to be worshipped** - Jesus said, "you shall worship the Lord your God, and him only shall you serve";
Satan can tempt you using scripture - he told Jesus that it is written that God will give his angels to be in charge of him to guard him and on their hands they will bear him up least he strike his foot against the a stone;

(b) Do you think it was necessary for Jesus to be tempted? Give reasons for your answer and show you have thought about different points of view. [8]

This part of the question was well answered by some candidates. Most effectively evaluated the need for Jesus to be tempted, commonly arguing that the experience prepared him for his ministry. Candidates also considered alternative viewpoints, with many suggesting that, as the Son of God, it was not necessary for Jesus to be tempted. However, some responses presented strong arguments but failed to make specific reference to the story outlined in part (a)(i). This omission weakened their answers and prevented them from achieving the highest Level 4. Additionally, a number of candidates presented non-religious arguments; these could not be awarded higher-level scores.

Expected response:

YES

It revealed Jesus' character – He did not get carried away by the attractive things the devil promised him, for instance, the kingdoms of the world; **It prepared Jesus for his upcoming ministry** - He was yet to come across many temptations in his ministry as he was to mingle with different groups of people, such as Pharisees and Sadducees.

NO

Jesus was the son of God - Because of his divine nature, he was likely to be aware of the temptations beforehand; **Jesus was omnipotent** - He had all the power to conquer any form of temptation.

Question 3

Candidates did not perform well in this question.

(ii) Give an account of the conflict where Jesus was asked about his authority. [6]

Candidates generally did not perform well on this part of the question. Few provided a comprehensive and well-developed account of the conflict between Jesus and the religious leaders. Some candidates focused on the trials of Jesus or on earlier conflicts, such as Jesus' claim to forgive sins in the healing of the paralytic and the question about paying taxes to Caesar. These responses did not address the requirements of the question and therefore were awarded level 0.

Expected response:

As Jesus was teaching the people in the temple and preaching the gospel; The chief priests and the scribes with the elders came; They asked him, "Tell us by what authority you do these things, or who it is that gave you this authority"; He answered them, "I will ask you a question, Was the baptism of John from heaven or from men?"; They discussed it with one another, saying, "If we say, 'From heaven,' he will say, 'Why did you not believe him?' But if we say, 'From men,' all the people will stone us; for they are convinced that John was a prophet." So, they answered that they did not know whence it was; And Jesus said to them, "Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things." (Luke 20:1-8).

(ii) Explain two character traits of Jesus shown by this incident.

[6]

Those who provided an accurate account of the conflict between Jesus and the religious leaders concerning the source of His authority were able to analyse the character traits of Jesus revealed through this incident. However, some candidates identified traits that are not explicitly supported by the account, such as “calm,” “spirit-filled,” and “compassionate.” It is important to train candidates to ensure that when analysing a person’s character, they select precise adjectives that are directly supported by biblical evidence.

Additionally, it was observed that some candidates still use multiple adjectives that convey the same trait, for example, “bold” and “brave,” treating them as separate points. Candidates should be guided to understand synonyms and avoid unnecessary repetition in their responses, ensuring clarity and conciseness in their analysis.

Expected response:

Wise/Clever/Smart - He did not give them a direct answer instead he asked them a question; **Authoritative** - He preached in the temple, yet he was not a priest/ By what authority do you do these things (Jesus had authority); **Bold/Brave** - he refused to tell them the source of his authority; **Strategic/ Omniscient** - Jesus knew that they were not going to answer his question

(b) Do you think the religious leaders were right to question Jesus about his authority? Give reasons for your answer and show you have thought about different points of view.

[8]

This part of the question was well-handled by a very few candidates. Those who scored higher marks were able to recognize and explain the significance of why it was justified for the religious leaders to question Jesus’ authority, as well as why some might argue it was not justified. They highlighted that the religious leaders were the custodians of the temple, while Jesus’ actions could be seen as trespassing, and noted that his growing following may have been a cause for concern. Strong responses considered multiple perspectives, including the fact that Jesus performed miracles openly and that, as experts in scripture, the religious leaders should have recognized him as the long-awaited Messiah. However, some candidates approached the question too casually, focusing on social aspects rather than grounding their argument in religious or scriptural reasoning, and others did not sufficiently address the specific conflict surrounding Jesus’ source of authority.

Expected response:

YES

It was their duty to preach in the temple - they had to question anyone else who was not a priest; **It was their duty to safeguard the operations of the temple** - One of the operations was teaching, so for anyone to teach in the temple they must have received their approval; **They needed clarity about Jesus' identity** - They were not sure who Jesus was as he had done a lot of things he was not supposed to do; **They felt threatened** - Jesus was gaining more popularity.

NO

Religious leaders should have been well-versed with scripture - Jesus portrayed all the characteristics of the long-awaited Messiah; **Jesus was the son of God** - He had authority to teach and preach in his father's house; **The intention was to trap Jesus** - they had already witnessed the extraordinary things Jesus had done, like healing, teaching, preaching.

Question 4

The question was fairly done by most candidates.

(a)(i) What happened when the women visited the tomb of Jesus at dawn?

This question was generally well answered by most candidates; they were able to accurately describe what occurred when the women visited Jesus' tomb at dawn. However, other candidates demonstrated limited knowledge of the account and missed critical information on what the two men in dazzling apparel said to the women. Some candidates summarised the account and omitted critical details such as the prophecy made by Jesus to his disciples before his death. Additionally, some focused on the account of Mathew of the visit to the tomb.

Expected responses:

They found the stone rolled away from the tomb; When they went inside they did not find the body; While they were still perplexed, two men stood by them in dazzling apparel; They were frightened and bowed their faces to the ground; The men said, "Why do you seek the living among the dead?; Remember how he told you, while he was still in Galilee; That the Son of man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, be crucified, and on the third day rise"; They remembered his words and they went to tell the eleven Apostles and the rest.(Luke 24:2-9).

(ii) Explain two reasons why the resurrection of Jesus was important.

[6]

This question was well answered by many candidates. Most were able to provide clear arguments explaining why the resurrection of Jesus was significant. The majority focused on points such as its fulfilment of Old Testament prophecies concerning the Messiah-that Jesus will die and resurrect on the third day, as well as the fulfilment of Jesus' own predictions prior to His death.

However, a few candidates argued that the resurrection was significant because it demonstrated the importance of women in Luke's Gospel. While this observation is valid, it did not earn marks, as it did not directly address the question asked.

Expected responses:

Proof that Jesus is the Messiah - the resurrection revealed his identity; **Fulfilment of Jesus' Prediction/ Fulfilment of Old Testament prophecies** - Jesus predicted his resurrection (Luke 13:31)/ It was prophesied that the Messiah will die and rise on the third day; **Assured them of their own Resurrection** - Jesus rose from the death and so humans too will rise; **God has power over death (Omnipotence)** - he rose from the dead.

(b) Do you think the disciples were right not to believe the report from the women? Give reasons for our answer and show you have thought about different points of view.

[8]

This part of the question was well-handled by many candidates, who presented strong arguments supported by references to the visit of the women to Jesus' tomb at early dawn, thereby earning maximum marks. These responses often highlighted that the disciples were also human and that it was unusual for someone to die and rise again. Conversely, many candidates argued that the disciples should have believed the women, since Jesus had foretold that He would rise on the third day.

A common error observed was that some candidates made inappropriate claims, such as asserting that women were liars or incapable of giving coherent accounts, rather than addressing the question contextually by discussing the role played by women in the incident. In addition, some candidates misread the question and responded as though it asked, *"Do you think the disciples were right to believe?"* when in fact it asked whether they were right *not* to believe. This misinterpretation resulted in a loss of marks.

Expected responses:

YES

They were human- it was not common for one to die and rise again; **Jesus did not show himself to the disciples** - they did not expect to get the report of Jesus' resurrection from women; **The report of an empty tomb did not necessarily confirm Jesus' promise of rising on the third day** – they may have thought his body had been stolen.

NO

They had been with Jesus for a long time - Jesus had repeatedly told them that he would die and rise on the third day; **They had seen Jesus raising people from the dead** - examples of the son of the widow of Nain and Jairus' daughter; Jesus was divine - he had power over death.

Conclusion

The 2025 EGCSE Religious Education Paper 1 examination showed a broadly comparable performance to 2024, with some candidates demonstrating excellent knowledge and evaluative skills. However, inconsistencies in answer structure, source usage, and depth of understanding highlight areas needing targeted guidance. With structured practice in continuous prose, effective use of sources, and strengthened evaluative and analytical skills, future cohorts can achieve higher, more consistent performance.

Recommendations

It is recommended that candidates should be:

- Trained to write in continuous prose and structure answers clearly.
- Guided to write within allocated spaces and to avoid redundancy.
- Encouraged to reinforce chronological and thematic sequencing in narrative answers.
- Encouraged to explicitly use biblical sources in all relevant questions.
- Trained to emphasize depth, accuracy, and relevance in responses.
- Trained to develop critical evaluation skills and balanced argumentation.
- Trained to strengthen character analysis using precise biblical evidence.

Paper 6893/02

General Comments

There has been an increase in the number of candidates who sat for the 2025 examination, from 17884 in 2024 to 20693 in 2025. There was a slight improvement on the overall performance compared to 2024. There were some learners who were able to obtain the highest mark which is 80 and very few 00 marks compared to 2024 where the latter was dominant. A few candidates left blank spaces, and those who did were in some specific questions instead of the whole paper.

The Religious Education teachers are commended for their dedication and tireless effort in equipping candidates with the necessary skills to respond to questions. Teachers are still encouraged to teach learners all the necessary skills and to give them more practice during the course of the year. Also, teachers are urged to constantly remind candidates to attempt all questions and to read questions with understanding in order to avoid giving irrelevant responses.

It is worth noting that most candidates managed to use the allocated time profitably. There were minimal rubric errors. However, it is still noted with much concern that some candidates still use pencils and make overwrites with pens, habits which are strongly discouraged. Candidates are required to use pens, if it occurs that they begin with a pencil, they should ensure that they erase the pencil before submitting their work. Teachers are advised to encourage candidates to read instructions carefully before responding to questions.

Comments on Assessment Objectives

AO 1: Knowledge and Understanding

There were some candidates who demonstrated a sound grasp of the material questioned. However, it was noted with great concern that some candidates are still unable to use the source when responding to Question 1. This made it impossible for them to attain top level marks. In addition, some candidates lacked the necessary skills needed in knowledge and understanding based questions. Such candidates could not achieve top level marks (6 marks). For knowledge, teachers are urged to teach learners to read and master each account so as to avoid confusing the different stories. Likewise, for understanding, teachers are encouraged to train learners to clearly unpack their points and to substantiate each point with evidence from the story. Most candidates failed to obtain top level marks in the understanding question due to their failure to use evidence from the account.

AO 2: Evaluation

A majority of candidates demonstrated fairly acceptable evaluation skills. They managed to offer more than one point of view and included Christian ideas as support. However, some candidates provided general arguments without making reference to the question asked.

Candidates must ensure that they clearly articulate their stand. They should also ensure that they acknowledge other points of view without confusing them as their 'own' point of view as well. For example; "on the other hand, some people may argue that..." instead of "I also think that..."

Candidates must also note that Religious Education Paper 2 is set on The Acts of the Apostles, as such their supportive details should come from within the context of the text. It has been noted with great concern that some candidates support their arguments with content from Luke, especially on questions based on miracles and persecution. Candidates are strongly encouraged to refrain from bringing content from the Gospel of Luke and stick to Acts of the Apostles.

Source Based Questions

Some candidates managed to make use of the source in Question 1. However, there are some candidates who still have a challenge in attaining full marks because of their failure to manipulate the source in their responses. Some candidates only use the source in (a) (i) and ignore it in (a) (ii) and (b). It is of great importance that candidates clearly interpret the source (unpack what they see in the source) and use it appropriately in their responses. Candidates should not just randomly use the expression '... as shown in the source' without clearly stating what exactly is shown in the source. The source should also be used where it is applicable, not anywhere or anyhow. This improvement in exam technique could assist candidates secure the highest level. It is necessary to use the source in all three part questions.

Comments on specific questions

Question 1

Generally, the question was fairly done. Some candidates were able to narrate the incidents which took place during the stoning of Paul at Lystra. However, some candidates gave irrelevant accounts while some just stated what they saw in the source. Some candidates failed to incorporate the source in all three part questions and a majority of candidates failed to interpret the source.

Those who performed well were able to use the source in all three part questions.

(a)(i) Narrate the incident shown in the source.

[6]

This part question was not well done. Some candidates confused the narration with the stoning of Stephen. Some candidates mistook the incident for a miracle performed by Paul. Some candidates were just stating what they see in the source without giving a detailed narration of the incident. Candidates with high level responses managed to give an orderly account of the stoning of Paul at Lystra with the correct interpretation of the source.

Expected responses:

Jews from Antioch and Iconium came to Lystra; They persuaded the people of Lystra against Paul and Barnabas; They stoned Paul and dragged him out of the city, supposing he was dead; The disciples gathered about him; He rose up and entered the city; On the next day, he went on with Barnabas to Derbe to preach the gospel (Acts 14:19-21).

(ii) Explain two reasons why Paul was stoned on this occasion.

[6]

This part question was fairly done as some candidates were able to identify and explain the reasons for the stoning of Paul. Some candidates were explaining the significance of Paul's persecution instead of reasons why he was stoned at Lystra. Common responses included that Paul was stoned because he refused to accept the sacrifices from the people of Lystra after the healing of the lame man. Most candidates also failed to manipulate the source in this part question. Some candidates were able to state reasons such as jealousy and anger from the part of the Jews but failed to substantiate with evidence from the account or other previous incidents leading to the stoning. For top level, candidates were expected to fully explain two reasons and to manipulate the source in their responses.

Expected responses:

Jealousy / Anger- Jews were jealous that Paul was gaining more followers and performing miracles; Stoning was a Jewish way of punishment- teaching about Jesus and the resurrection offended the Jews; Religious leaders felt threatened- it was their duty to preach in the synagogues; Fulfilment of the declaration (prophecy) made by God during Saul's conversion- suffering for the gospel.

(b) Do you think the event shown in the source is relevant to Christians today? Give reasons for your answer and show you have thought about different points of view.

This part question was fairly done as most candidates were able to give both sides of the argument. Also, most candidates were able to identify different forms of persecution faced by Christians today such as arrest, rejection, hatred, judgement, criticism, stigma, discrimination, cyber bullying, etc. However, some candidates failed to argue whether persecution is still relevant and focused on why it is still necessary or important. This led to the attainment of lower marks since the question requires candidates to focus on the practicality of persecution (whether it still occurs or not) not its necessity or importance.

Level 4 responses are those with both sides of the argument with a clear stand and reference to the source.

Expected responses included, but not limited to:

Yes

Some Christians still suffer persecution for their faith- just like Paul suffered at Lystra; Most Christians demonstrate perseverance in times of persecution- Paul went back to the city where he was persecuted; There are still missionaries who are committed to taking the gospel to foreign countries- Paul went to Lystra and Derbe to preach.

No

Most Christians no longer suffer for their faith- those who do, suffer because of their unacceptable behaviour; Christianity has become an acceptable and dominant religion in most countries- Christians are allowed to freely preach the gospel anywhere and at anytime; Some Christians are no longer resilient in the face of persecution- some Christians especially preachers stop preaching in the face of persecution; Human rights have minimised persecution- today's society use courts rather than stoning to deal with supposed law-breakers.

Question 2

This question was fairly done as most candidates made an attempt to outline Peter and John's first trial before the Sanhedrin and the reasons why the apostles were arrested. However, some candidates lacked knowledge of the first trial and focused on the incident of the healing of the lame man at the Beautiful Gate as well as the apostles' arrest. Some candidates mistakenly confused the first trial with the second arrest and Gamaliel's speech to the Sanhedrin.

(a)(i) Outline Peter and John's first trial before the Sanhedrin.

[6]

This part question was fairly done as most candidates were able to clearly outline Peter and John's first trial before the Sanhedrin. However, some candidates gave an account of the healing of the lame man at the Beautiful Gate, the first arrest and Gamaliel's speech instead of the trial. Some candidates who made an attempt to outline the trial gave little details from the incident which resulted in them obtaining low level marks.

Level 4 responses were those who gave a detailed and chronological outline of the trial.

Expected responses:

Setting/ Background information- After the healing of the lame man, Peter and John were brought before the Sanhedrin; **Accusation-** The Sanhedrin enquired, "By what power or by what name did you do this?" **Peter's Defence-** Peter stated that it was by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth whom they had crucified but God raised from the dead; **Sanhedrin's judgement-** Seeing that the man who had been healed was there, they had nothing to say in opposition; They sent them outside of the council to discuss among themselves; They then warned them not to speak or teach in the name of Jesus; **Peter and John's reaction-** Peter and John asked them to judge for themselves whether it was right to obey God or men; **Threat/Release-** The Sanhedrin threatened Peter and John and let them go (Acts 4:5-22).

(ii) Explain two reasons why Peter and John were arrested.

[6]

This part question was fairly done. Most candidates were able to give reasons why Peter and John were arrested, without elaborating on the reasons given. Common responses included the healing of the lame man and the spreading of the gospel. These responses just appear as knowledge and do not necessarily reveal the exact reasons why the apostles were arrested. It is only when the candidates refer to jealousy, anger or hatred of the Sanhedrin caused by the miracle performance and the preaching that the responses demonstrate candidates' understanding.

Expected responses:

The apostles were seen to be disturbing the peace in the Temple- after the healing of the lame man at the Beautiful Gate, all the people ran together to the apostles; The Sanhedrin was jealous- the man was not healed by them; The apostles were gaining more popularity- the Sanhedrin felt Peter and John were not qualified to address the people/ it was the responsibility of the high priest to teach at the Temple; The Sanhedrin hated the apostles' teaching on the resurrection of the dead/ Teaching about the Messiah/ Teachings against the Law of Moses- the Sadducees did not believe in the resurrection/ Jews did not believe Jesus was the Messiah/ Sanhedrin believed in and taught about the Law of Moses.

(b) Do you think the Sanhedrin was right to arrest Peter and John? Give reasons for your answer and show you have thought about different points of view. [8]

This part question was fairly done. Most candidates were able to display the evaluation skill. They gave both sides of the argument. However, some candidates failed to bring evidence from Peter and John's first trial or arrest but were referring to the healing of the lame man at the Beautiful Gate. Candidates who performed well in this question are those who observed that the affirmative side of the argument addresses the reasons why the Sanhedrin arrested Peter and John as elaborated in (a) (ii).

Level 4 responses had both sides of the argument supported with reference from Peter and John's first arrest and trial.

Expected responses included, but not limited to:

Yes

Teaching in the Temple was the High Priests' responsibility- so Peter and John were trespassing; Teaching about the resurrection of Jesus provoked the Sanhedrin- Sadducees did not believe in life after death; The apostles were gaining more popularity- Sanhedrin felt Peter and John were not qualified to address the people; The apostles were seen to be disturbing the peace of the Temple- after the healing of the lame man, all the people ran together to the apostles.

No

The apostles had helped a sick man- the lame man was crippled for forty years; The apostles were innocent of the charges- the apostles were preaching in the name of Jesus; The members of the council were protecting their ego- they arrested Peter and John because they felt that they were losing popularity.

Question 3

This question was fairly done by most candidates, with some candidates giving an accurate account while some confused the miracle with other miracles performed by Peter such as the healing of Tabitha and the healing of the lame man at the Beautiful Gate. Some candidates narrated the healing of the lame man at Lystra. This confusion of accounts led to learners attaining lower marks in both (a) (i) and (a) (ii) since they could not explain Peter's character traits correctly.

(a)(i) Give an account of the healing of Aeneas.

[6]

This part question was fairly done as some candidates gave an account of other miracles in Acts instead of the healing of Aeneas. Those who gave the correct account obtained higher marks. Common responses included the raising of Tabitha at Joppa, the healing of the lame man at the Beautiful Gate, the healing of the lame man at Lystra and the raising of Eutychus at Troas. Some candidates mixed different miracles in one account thus leading to distortion of information. Candidates are encouraged to read all the miracles in Acts and be able to distinguish them by their setting, key characters and key incidents.

Expected responses:

Peter came down to the saints at Lydda; There he found a man named Aeneas who had been bedridden for eight years and was paralysed; Peter said to him, "Aeneas, Jesus Christ heals you; Rise and make your bed; And immediately he rose; All the residents of Lydda and Sharon saw him and they turned to the Lord (Acts 9:32-35).

(ii) Explain two lessons that can be learnt about Peter from the miracle.

[6]

This part question was fairly done as some candidates were explaining lessons learnt from the miracle instead of Peter's character. Candidates are still encouraged to read questions with understanding before responding. A common character trait used by candidates was that Peter was spirit-filled which does not qualify as a character trait. Teachers are therefore encouraged to clarify to learners that being filled with the Holy Spirit is not a character trait but it should be clear what the Holy Spirit enabled Peter to do which then becomes the character trait. Eg, Peter was authoritative, which is a character trait demonstrating the Holy Spirit at work. It was also noted with much concern that candidates are still unable to differentiate between 'Having faith' and being 'Faithful' thus a majority of candidates used the word 'faithful' to explain Peter's character which was incorrect in this incident.

Expected responses:

Peter was Committed/Dedicated- he was moving around then he came down to the saints that lived at Lydda; **Peter was compassionate/ Loving/ Caring/ Sympathetic-** when he saw Aeneas he was moved by his condition and healed him; **Peter had faith-** he believed that Aeneas was going to be healed through Jesus Christ; **Peter was authoritative-** he commanded Aeneas to rise and he immediately arose; **Peter was humble-** he acknowledged that Aeneas was healed by Jesus and never took the glory unto himself.

(b) Do you think today's religious leaders can still perform miracles? Give reasons for your answer and show you have thought about different points of view. [8]

This part question was well done by most candidates. A majority of candidates were able to demonstrate the evaluation skill well by giving both sides of the argument. Most candidates were able to acknowledge that for one to be able to perform a miracle they must be filled with the Holy Spirit and must have faith. However, it was noted with concern that some candidates use the content from the Gospel of Luke as evidence instead of the miracle in (a) (i). Some candidates referred to any miracle in Acts which is not wrong but for higher level marks, candidates are required to refer to the account in (a) (i). Candidates who failed to make reference to the healing of Aeneas obtained level 3.

Level 4 responses had both sides of the argument with reference to the healing of Aeneas.

Expected responses included, but not limited to:

Yes

Today's religious leaders are led by the same God- healing comes from God; As long as they have faith- faith and healing go hand in hand; They are still filled with the Holy Spirit- which enables them to perform miracles; Testimonies are evidence- those who have experienced miracles deliver testimonies.

No

They no longer have faith in God- in order to perform miracles, you need to have faith; Their attempts to perform miracles fail- people get healed temporarily.

Question 4

This question was not well done by a majority of candidates. Few candidates demonstrated knowledge of the incidents which took place at daybreak during the shipwreck. Some candidates related the incidents which took place at night while some narrated what happened during Paul and the sailors' arrival at Malta.

(a)(i) Relate what happened during the shipwreck at daybreak on the island of Malta. [6]

This part question was not well done by most candidates. A few candidates managed to recall what happened during the shipwreck at daybreak and were able to achieve Level 4. Those who remembered the soldiers' reaction and the centurion's command could not score beyond Level 2. Some candidates related irrelevant accounts such as the incidents which took place during the shipwreck at night. Some confused the incident with the sailors' reception at Malta which are all irrelevant accounts.

Top level responses were from candidates who related an accurate and chronological account of the incidents which took place during the shipwreck, specifically at daybreak.

Expected responses:

It was day, the sailors did not recognise the land but noticed a bay with a beach; They cast off the anchors and left them in the sea; They loosened the ropes that tied the rudders; They hoisted the foresail to the wind and made for the beach; Striking a shoal, they ran the vessel aground; The bow stuck and remained immovable and the stern was broken up by the surf; The soldiers' plan was to kill the prisoners lest any should swim away and escape but the centurion objected; He ordered those who could swim to do so and the rest to use planks or pieces of the ship to escape to the land (Acts 27: 39-44).

(ii) Explain two reasons why it was important for Paul to reach Rome.

[6]

This part question was well done by most candidates. Most candidates were able to explain the reasons why it was important for Paul reach Rome. However, some candidates failed to substantiate their points with evidence from the book of Acts which was mandatory for a top-level mark. Some candidates gave incomplete points by just stating a verse instead of the message of the verse. For instance, responses such as "It was a fulfilment of Acts 1:8..." were common and candidates have to be strongly discouraged from giving such responses because no marks will be obtained from such responses. The message carried by the verse is what is required for a mark.

Expected responses:

To get justice/Fair trial- Paul had requested to be tried before Caesar; **To fulfil the Great Commission/ Universalism of the gospel-** Jesus commanded his disciples to spread the gospel to the ends of the earth; **To fulfil God's command** (Acts 23:11)- the Lord told Paul to testify about Him in Rome just as he had testified in Jerusalem; **Paul wanted to exercise his right as a Roman citizen-** he had a right to go to Rome as a Roman citizen/ He had revealed his Roman citizenship at Philippi, before Claudius Lysias; **Fulfilment of the declaration or prophecy made by God during Saul's conversion** (Acts 9:15-16)- God told Paul that he is a chosen instrument to carry His name before the Gentiles and kings and sons of Israel...".

(b) Do you think the soldiers' plan to kill the prisoners during the shipwreck was justified? Give reasons for your answer and show you have thought about different points of view.

[8]

This part question was fairly done by a significant number of candidates. Most candidates demonstrated the evaluation skill by giving different points of view. However, some candidates were giving general arguments related to their knowledge and understanding of prisoners and the role of soldiers without specifically making

reference to the events that took place during the shipwreck. Some candidates made reference to the incident of the jailer in Philippi which is also not wrong but a top level mark was awarded to candidates who made reference to the incident in (a) (i). Some candidates gave irrelevant arguments which led them into scoring Level 1.

A Level 4 response included valid opinion about different points of view, well supported by evidence and argument from the incidents which took place during the shipwreck.

Expected responses included, but not limited to:

Yes

The prisoners were likely to escape- the ship was damaged and the prisoners were likely to swim and escape; The soldiers feared for their lives- the Roman law dictated that if a prisoner escapes, the one in charge should be killed.

No

Killing the prisoners could have destroyed God's plan – Paul was supposed to reach Rome as per God's command in Acts 23:11; The prisoners' lives were already in danger- even if they escaped some would have not reached land; Life is sacred- killing is a sin.

Recommendations

It is recommended that:

- Candidates should be made familiar with the meaning of the command words so that they will be able to understand the demands of the questions i.e. The expectations for 'Outline' and 'Give an account/Relate/Narrate'.
- Candidates should read and clearly understand questions and be able to differentiate between a question on significance, characteristics of Luke's Gospel, lessons and character.
- Candidates should be guided on the correct adjectives to use when analysing characters.
- Candidates should be urged to make a list of synonyms for each character trait to avoid using similar character traits as separate points and also be discouraged from using similar evidence for separate points.
- The mark allocation and other guiding information per question should guide candidates on how many reasons to discuss. If a question demands **two** reasons / **two** lessons / **two** character traits, candidates are expected to explain two, **NOT** three or more.

- Emphasis should be made on the reference to the account in both (a) (ii) and (b). When demonstrating understanding, analysis and interpretation, candidates should be encouraged to draw evidence from the account (or generally the book of Acts for some questions). Similarly, when evaluating, candidates should make reference to the account for a top level mark.
- Emphasis should be made on the usage of the Acts of the Apostles as evidence for explanations and evaluations. Candidates should be discouraged from making reference to the Gospel according to Luke.
- Candidates should be properly and thoroughly trained on using the source in Question 1. They should be encouraged to refer to the source in all three part questions. They should interpret the source, instead of just mentioning it i.e. Avoid using statements such as 'As seen in the source' without being specific as to what is seen in the source.
- Teachers are encouraged to familiarise candidates with the whole syllabus as it has been noted that some candidates were failing to respond to questions set from incidents which appear towards the end of the syllabus.

